

Technical Report Writing

From,

Date: 1/11/2017

Dr. Lakshmi

Student-Teacher Hostel Committee

Faculty of Arts and Humanities

XYZ University

To,

The Dean

Faculty of Arts and Humanities

XYZ University

Subject: Report of the Student-Teacher Hostel Committee, XYZ University, on the problems of newcomers seeking hostel accommodation

1. Purpose or Background:

Following a proposal from the Faculty of Arts and Humanities Students' Union, XYZ University, a Student- Teacher Committee was set up on 1st November 2017 by the Dean of the Faculty to look into the problems of those newcomers to the Faculty courses who needed hostel accommodation.

The committee consisted of the Dean, Chairperson, the Heads of all Departments of the Faculty, the Dean of Students, and four student representatives, whose names were forwarded by the union.

The Committee was asked to investigate the current problems and to recommend remedial measures. It was asked to submit its report by the end of November 2017.

2. Work Completed:

The committee made the following enquiries before drafting its observations:

a) The documents for the last ten years were checked by the Admissions Office to determine the extent by which the demand for hostel accommodation exceeded supply.

b) Questionnaires were circulated among all present residents and the applicants for the academic session 2017-2018 to find out the usual period of wait for applicants.

3. **Work Scheduled:**

The Hostel Superintendents, the Admissions Office and the Dean of Students enquired the committee on the following matters:

- a) The criteria adopted in allotting rooms
- b) The proportion of new undergraduate to postgraduate applicants among those accommodated
- c) The academic profile of newcomers admitted to the hostel
- d) Alternative arrangements suggested to and adopted by unsuccessful applicants.

4. **Problems:**

- a) Only 65% of undergraduate applicants and 70% of postgraduate applicants could be accommodated in the University hostel.
- b) The criteria at present adopted in allotting rooms favour academic merit. At present, most unsuccessful candidates stay

with friends and relatives. Very few can afford rented accommodation outside the campus.

c) A few newcomers felt the need to ensure more prompt care in medical emergencies. A hostel superintendent expressed concern over the security which allows undesirable outsiders.

d) The Committee found drinking water facilities in most hostels, especially the postgraduate and women's hostels, inadequate. There is an acute scarcity of water in PG hostel especially during the summer months.

e) Although most applicants are allotted rooms on joining, each year at least 10% of allottees have to wait for three to four months since outgoing residents do not always vacate the rooms on time.

5. Recommendations:

a) There is an urgent need to increase the total number of seats available.

b) All allottees should have assured accommodation on joining. This would require such measures as withholding of certificates and mark sheets of those who are reluctant to vacate their rooms after the expiry of their tenure.

c) At least 70% of the total accommodation available should be reserved for those who live beyond a distance of 200kms from the campus.

d) The Students' Union could help pool information and bring together newcomers who are willing to share off-campus rooms.

e) Each hostel should have a first-aid kit and the University clinic should be better supplied with medicines needed in an emergency.

f) Each hostel should be equipped with at least one water depolluting equipment per 25 inmates and a set of fire extinguishers.

Signatures of the members of the Committee